

Schubert Cherry

Prunus virginiana 'Schubert'



Origin

Discovered growing wild along the Missouri River near Bismarck, North Dakota, and introduced as a cultivated variety by the Oscar H. Will Company nursery in 1943.

Look for

It's one of the only street trees where a single tree can show both green and purple leaves at the same time, because new leaves emerge green and only turn purple as they mature through the season.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf color: both green (new) and purple (mature) leaves visible on the same tree at once.
- Flower: small white clusters bloom while leaves are still mostly green.
- Bark: smooth with lenticel dashes, similar to other cherries.
- Commonly confused with: purple leaf plum (Schubert cherry shows a green-to-purple gradient across one tree, while purple leaf plum's leaves are purple from the start).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Small white flower clusters bloom while leaves are still green.
Summer	Leaves gradually shift from green to reddish-purple as the season goes on.
Fall	Leaves stay deep purple until they drop.
Winter	Smooth bark with lenticel dashes, similar to other ornamental cherries.

DID YOU KNOW

- It was found growing wild by a nurseryman named Schubert, which is where the name comes from -- not a place or a person it was named after after the fact.
- Because it was selected from a naturally cold-hardy wild population, it tolerates much colder winters than many other ornamental cherries.